



If you can't afford it all, you'll have to choose between a widescreen and touchscreen

you need to collaborate and sit with others looking at screens, a laptop might be the better option as they have physically larger screens. It's a toss-up though, and you're going to have to make up your own mind here based on your unique requirements.

BEST RESALE VALUE = LAPTOP

Discounting iPads, most Android tablets don't have very good resale value – apart from Nexus tablets. Even flagship tablets launched by very reputable brands feel slower and sluggish after a year of usage, amounting to less than premium returns on websites such as eBay, OLX and Quikr, for example. Why do Nexus tablets do slightly better in the resale market than the average tablet? Simply because of their longevity in terms of operating system

and support for latest Android updates. But overall, as a product category, tablets is one of fast diminishing returns.

Laptops don't suffer as badly from that problem. If, for whatever reason, you plan to sell a laptop after just a year of using it, in terms of percentage value, it will offer better returns than a tablet – if both of them suffer from the same amount of wear and tear, presumably. Why this dichotomy? The incremental updates witnessed in hardware platform on the laptop side differs less and less every year and the line representing OS-level changes is largely flat as well. Also, you can run Windows 10 on a five year old laptop – without voiding warranty or jumping through hoops or worrying about “bricking” your machine. You don't have

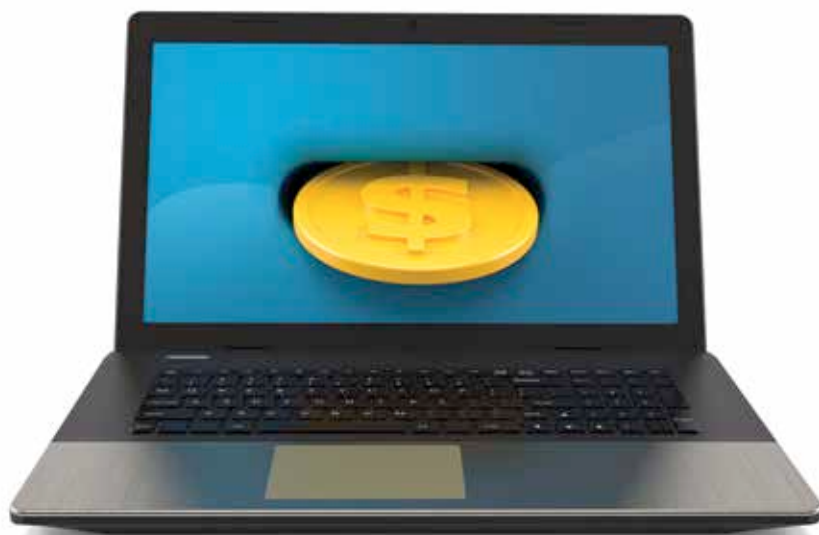
any of these luxuries on a tablet which is one year old, which you're about to list on eBay, thus impacting its resale value far more negatively. Also the price points that tablets sell at are so much more affordable than a laptop's, people don't think about just flat out buying newer devices without a second thought – which is not the case with a laptop.

WHICH ONE?

Both laptops and tablets have their strengths and weaknesses. The thing about tablets is that they're extremely convenient and easy to use. If you're going to be working on your web browser, Google docs, listening to YouTube videos and streaming movies and music off the web – without having to take a lot of printouts from your printer and other stuff for your project, etc. – you're better off buying a tablet. There's no denying its highly ultraportable form factor and it's great for one-handed use (compared to a laptop) any given day. It can also double up as an ebook reader, and is undoubtedly the more multifaceted device when you stack it against a traditional laptop.

However, we can't deny that a laptop is definitely the closest to a PC in this comparison, and therefore is the most versatile. When you need to run certain software, or need a larger HDD to store stuff on, or need to fire up something to quickly get work done, a laptop will always beat a tablet. When it comes to college projects and doing research with 50 browsers tabs open, you're going to be yearning for a laptop if all you have is a tablet. Android or iOS just cannot compete with full-blown Windows when it comes to productivity. You're going to also have to consider your specific requirements. If your college has physical LAN and no Wi-Fi, you have to choose a laptop. If you need to print a lot of stuff and format documents, again, a laptop. If you need to do video editing, image editing, and yes, gaming, you need a laptop.

However, if you're in a more creative field, need to draw, don't play serious games, and yes, we'll say it, want to show off just a little, an iPad Pro just looks way cooler than a boring laptop... We never said the choice would be easy, we just said we'd have you thinking about stuff logically... What's it going to be? Write in and let us know. 



You can sell a laptop for a decent price, but not a tablet